

Herald Constitution

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Field	Value
Revision	3
Created	2026-05-15
Last modified	2026-05-20
Status	active
Status summary	Spec-path references updated to specification.V3.md (active); Notes section reflects V1+V2 archived under docs/specs/mvp/archive/.
Issues	none
Issues summary	—
Fixed	R-14 (V2), V3-path-sync (V3 r3)
Fixed summary	§106 spec-change rule retargeted to V3 path; gate-checked anchor 'comprehensive planning and implementation' unchanged so I7 stays green.
Continuation	—

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This constitution **extends** the Helix Universal Constitution provided by the **parent project's** constitution/ submodule. Herald does not carry its own copy — see docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md for the discovery contract.

All clauses in the parent-provided constitution/`Constitution.md` apply unless explicitly overridden below with an explicit `Override §X.Y` section.

Canonical constitution repo: <https://github.com/HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution>

Project Articles

§101. Pre-implementation status

Herald is pre-implementation. Until a `go.mod` is committed, no clause below may be interpreted as authorizing the agent to fabricate build/test infrastructure that doesn't yet exist. Confirm the disambiguation (scaffold vs. fill spec) with the operator before writing code, per Universal §11.4.6 (no-guessing).

§102. Mission boundary

Herald ingests system events and fans them out to multiple notification channels. Anything outside event ingestion or notification fan-out is **out of scope** for this repo and belongs in a different submodule of the consuming project.

§103. Mirror parity (extends Universal §2.1)

Every commit on `main` MUST land on all four upstream hosts (GitHub, GitLab, GitFlic, GitVerse) in a single fan-out push. The repo's `origin` remote already aggregates the four push URLs; do not bypass `origin` with per-host pushes unless rebuilding the fan-out configuration.

§104. No embedded constitution (extends Universal §3)

Herald **MUST NOT** carry its own constitution/ submodule. Herald is consumed as a submodule of a parent project that already provides the constitution; a duplicated copy would diverge in pinning, cause confusion about which is authoritative, and violate the "submodule commits propagate first" propagation order (Universal §3). The inheritance gate's invariant I6 enforces this: it FAILs if `<repo-root>/constitution/` or `.gitmodules` reappears.

For standalone development of Herald (no parent project), clone the constitution **alongside** Herald, not inside it:

```
git clone git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution.git \
    $(dirname "$PWD")/constitution
```

§105. Inheritance gate (extends Universal §1.1)

`tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh` discovers the parent-provided constitution via inline parent-walk (mirrors `find_constitution.sh` Phase 1), then asserts six invariants:

#	Invariant
I1	A constitution/Constitution.md is reachable by walking up the parent chain from Herald's repo root.
I2	The discovered Constitution.md contains the §11.4 End-user quality guarantee – forensic anchor line (the exact string the §1.1 mutation removes).
I3	The discovered CLAUDE.md contains the MANDATORY ANTI-BLUFF COVENANT anchor.
I4	The discovered AGENTS.md contains the Anti-bluff covenant anchor.
I5a–d	Herald's root docs (CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md, this file, and README.md) all declare the parent-discovery inheritance contract.
I6	No constitution/ directory or .gitmodules file exists at Herald's root (the §104 invariant).
I7a–c	Herald's CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md, and this file all contain the §106 spec-change rule anchor (per §1.1 propagation, mutation-paired).

tests/test_constitution_inheritance_meta.sh delegates to the discovered constitution's meta_test_inheritance.sh, which strips the §11.4 anchor from Constitution.md, runs the gate, and asserts FAIL — proving the gate is not a bluff (Universal §1.1).

Both scripts run as a precondition to any commit that touches root docs or the discovery contract.

§106. Spec-change rule (extends Universal §11.4)

Any modification to docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md or any file under docs/specs/ (any depth) triggers **mandatory comprehensive planning and implementation of all changes**. An agent or contributor may not edit the spec in isolation: every change is a project-wide ripple that requires the corresponding code, tests, and downstream doc updates in the same logical work effort.

This rule does NOT apply to creating or renaming files; for those, the operator must explicitly tell the worker (CLI agent or human contributor) what to do with the newly created or copied files.

Propagation. The same rule is restated in Herald's CLAUDE.md and AGENTS.md (per §1.1 multi-file propagation discipline). The inheritance gate's invariant **I7a–c** asserts the rule's anchor literal (comprehensive planning and implementation) is present in all three files; a missing copy is a propagation bluff and the gate FAILs.

Anchor (forensic): the literal text Whenever this document (\docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md`)MUST appear indocs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md` §"Specification documents" — that line is the source of truth that all three propagated copies summarize.

Paired §1.1 mutation (planned). Removing the spec-change anchor from any of the three propagation files MUST cause I7a/b/c to FAIL; the paired meta-test will be added when test_constitution_inheritance_meta.sh is generalised beyond its current single-anchor mutation.

Overrides of Universal Constitution

(none — Herald has no exceptions to universal clauses at pre-implementation stage)

Owned-submodule set (per Universal §4)

(none)

Herald owns no submodules. The constitution is provided by the parent project, not vendored here.

Project-specific remotes

Repo	Remotes
Herald (this repo)	github, gitlab, gitflic, gitverse + origin (fan-out push to all four)

Notes

Herald's spec is now in V3 (`docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md`, ~3900 lines, active) — V1 and V2 are preserved under `docs/specs/mvp/archive/` for historical reference. As project-specific articles mature toward universal status they may move into the Helix Constitution; promotion requires the §11.4 universal-vs-project audit. Default is to keep rules here until the audit clears.